



08/11/2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8jE5njKdBNw
Publication Date	2026-08-12T10:26:19Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees

Date: August 11, 2026

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

The transcript indicates no statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Williams called the meeting to order [00:01:20](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, and President Williams. (Dr. Washburn arrived later during roll call [00:02:00](#)).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance led by President Williams [00:01:20](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *The transcript does not explicitly record a vote or discussion regarding the approval of prior meeting minutes.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:10:31](#) **Consent Agenda & Staff Recognition**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President Williams and Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board welcomed Miss Robin Moore as the new assistant principal at North Side Middle School. Miss Moore shared her background working with IPS (Cold Spring School and Marian University) and starting her career as a piano accompanist at North.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:13:12](#).
- [00:13:21](#) **Resolution: Employee Compensation & Support Staff Packages (2026<U+2013>2027 Academic Year)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Heater (Compensation Committee) alongside Brad and Chuck (financial staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The compensation committee presented proposals balancing financial uncertainty (such as future funding impacts from SEA1) against the need to keep pay competitive.
 - **Teachers:** Highly effective teachers receive a \$1,500 base pay increase; effective teachers receive \$1,000. Minimum teacher starting pay moves from \$52,000 to \$52,500. Building teachers of the year receive a \$1,000 stipend (shifted from salary to stipend); District Teacher of the Year receives an additional \$1,000 stipend. Speech-language-pathology teachers receive a \$1,500 per semester increase. Total teacher increase equates to ~\$392,000 (1.8% increase).
 - **Support Staff:** Modest hourly wage increases across the board. Retention stipends are maintained at \$300 per payment across three payments per year (reduced from \$500 previously). Total support staff increase equates to ~\$119,000 (1.6% increase).
 - **Extracurricular Activities (ECA):** Modest stipend adjustments totaling ~\$11,000, including adding an event manager and esports position adjustments, with tutoring hourly rates moving to \$16.70.
 - **Administration:** Increases total \$47,000 (1.2% increase).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:29:49](#).
- [00:30:48](#) **Presentation & Permission to Advertise: 2027 Budget**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck (Financial Staff).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Staff presented the 2027 calendar year budget for permission to advertise. The budget covers major funding buckets: Education Fund (\$44.3 million advertised spending, supported by state enrollment grants), Operation Fund (\$12.6 million advertised spending, supported by local property taxes and transfers), Debt Service (\$10.5 million), and the Rainy Day Fund. Staff noted strategic compliance with Department of Local Government Finance (DLGF) instructions to advertise assessed valuations artificially low (at roughly 70% of the previous year) to ensure tax rates are advertised high and protected from under-collection. Potential budget threats discussed included flat state basic grants, the upcoming dissolution of the special ed co-op, the loss of Meridian Health nursing grants, potential new charter/micro schools, and the long-term impact of SEA1 property tax caps.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Permission to Advertise granted) [00:15:01](#).
- **00:06:21 Public Hearing & Resolutions: General Obligation (GO) Bond Project (\$6.8 Million)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Chuck.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board opened and conducted a public hearing on a proposed \$6.8 million General Obligation (GO) bond project focused on district-wide roofing, paving improvements, and energy-efficient LED replacements at Muncie Central High School. Financial consultants Baker Tilly structured the bond with an anticipated short payback term of approximately five years.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None offered during the public hearing.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Following the close of the public hearing, the board approved three governing resolutions (Exhibit A: Project Resolution, Exhibit B: Preliminary Bond Resolution, and Exhibit C: Declaration of Official Intent to Reimburse Expenditures) by Voice Vote [00:12:31](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period ([00:10:33](#)).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds highlighted quarterly newsletters launching via Parent Square, opening days of school celebrations, new teacher orientations, and the success of the

Muncie Central High School marching band winning top visual, color guard, and percussion awards in recent competitions.

- The board announced the upcoming **Alumni Educators Reception** scheduled for **Friday, August 21, 2026** (6:00 PM reception, 7:00 PM kickoff) at the Muncie Central vs. Delta football game, honoring newly hired MCS teachers and teachers who are MCS alumni.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [00:18:17](#).

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